Versioning in ASP.Net Core Web API

Overview



What is API Versioning?

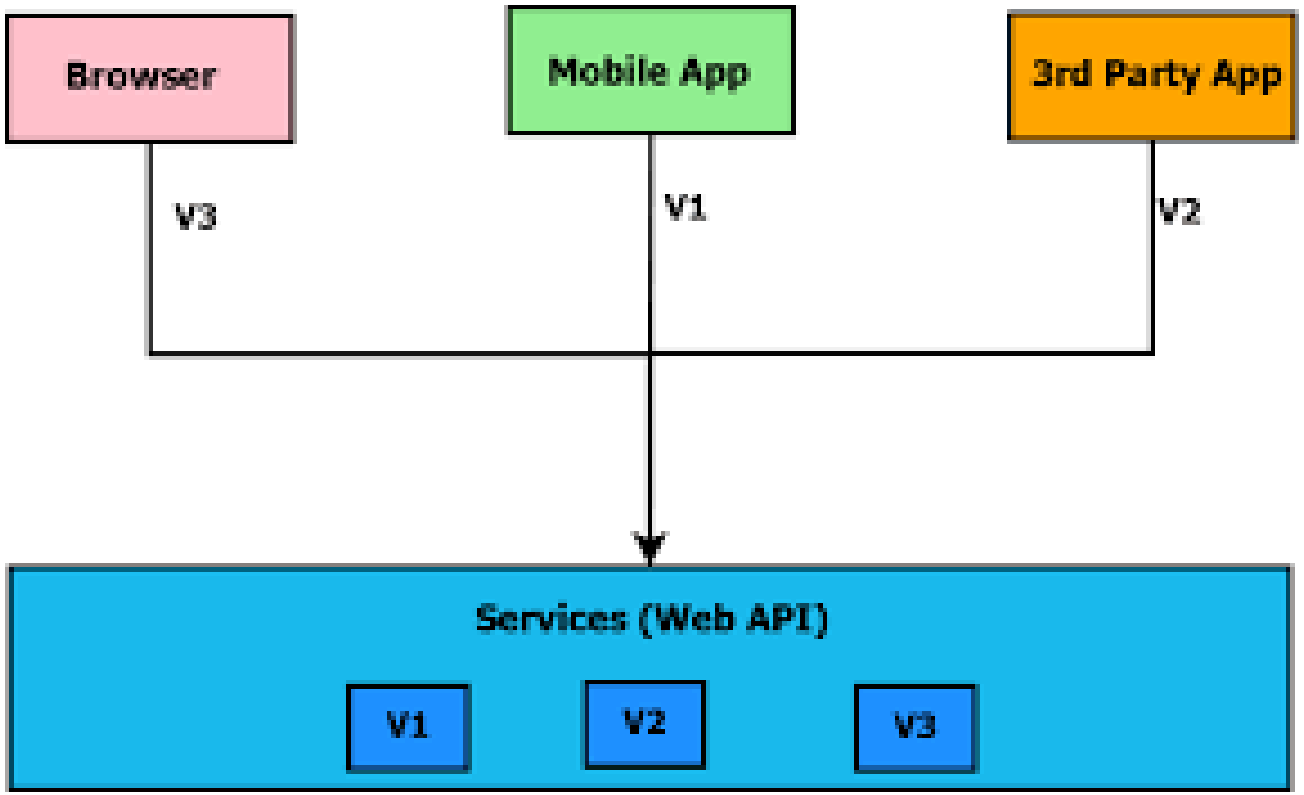
Why the API versioning is important?

Different Strategies of API versioning

Example

What is API Versioning?

- API versioning is a practice in software development where multiple versions of an API (Application Programming Interface) are maintained concurrently. This allows developers to introduce changes, enhancements, or even breaking changes to an API while ensuring that existing clients can continue to function without disruption.



Why the API versioning is important?

There are several reasons why API versioning is important:

- **Compatibility:** As software evolves, changes to the API may be necessary. Versioning allows these changes to be made without breaking existing client applications that rely on the API.
- **Backward Compatibility:** Versioning ensures that newer versions of the API can coexist with older versions. This allows clients to upgrade at their own pace, without forcing them to immediately adopt the latest version.
- **Feature Rollout:** Versioning can also be used to gradually roll out new features or experimental endpoints without impacting existing clients. This can be achieved by introducing a new version of the API alongside the existing one.

Different Stratagies of API versioning

- **URI Versioning:** Version information is included directly in the URI of the API endpoints, typically as part of the path, such as **/api/v1/resource.**
- **Query Parameter Versioning:** Version information is passed as a query parameter in the API request, such as **/api/resource?version=1.**
- **Header Versioning:** Version information is included in a custom HTTP header, such as **X-API-Version: 1.**
- **Media Type Versioning:** Version information is specified in the Accept header of the HTTP request, such as **Accept: application/vnd.yourapi.v1+json.**

References

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